1.

To employ her
construction ball
Morning fed on the
light blue wood
of the mouth
cannot understand
feels deeply)

2.

A wave of nausea—
numerals

3.

a few berries

4.

the unseen claw
Babe asked today
The background of poles roped over
into star jolted them

5.

filthy or into backward drenched flung heaviness
lemons asleep pattern crying

6.

The month of elephant—
embroidery over where
ill page sees.

7.

What might have
children singing
the horses
the seven
breaths under tree, fog
clasped—absolute, unthinking
menace to our way of life.
uh unearth more cloth
This could have been done—
This could not be done

1902. Wesleyan University Press.
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EBSCO Publishing: eBook Collection (EBSCOhost) printed on 10/19/2025 3:40:31 PM UTC via GEORGIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY 45129; John Ashbery; The Tennis Court Oath : A Book of Poems Account:ehost.

8.

In the falling twilight of the wintry afternoon all looked dull and cheerless. The car stood outside with Ronald Pryor and Collins attending to some slight engine trouble—the fast, open car which Ronnie sometimes used to such advantage. It was covered with mud, after the long run from Suffolk, for they had started from Harbury long before daylight, and, until an hour ago, had been moving swiftly up the Great North Road, by way of Stanford, Grantham and Doncaster to York. There they had turned away to Ripon, where, for an hour, they had eaten and rested. In a basket the waiter had placed some cold food with some bread and a bottle of wine, and this had been duly transferred to the car.

All was now ready for the continuance of the journey.

9.

The decision in his life
soul elsewhere
the gray hills
out there on the road darkness
covering lieutenant

there is a cure

10.

He had mistaken his book for garbage

11.

The editor realized
its gradual abandonment
a kind of block where other men come down
spoiling the view
wept blood
on the first page and following snow
gosh flowers upset ritual
a mass of black doves
over the scooter, snow outlining the tub
flowers until dawn

12.

that surgeon must operate

I had come across

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to the railway from the Great North
Road, which I had followed up to London.

13.

the human waste cannibals designed the master and his life

robot you underground sorrow to the end
can unlack horsemen. Storm seems berries—
until the truth can be explained
Nothing can exist. Rain
blossomed in the highlands—a
secret to annul grass sticks—razor today engraved sobs.
The lion's skin—ears, to travel.

14.

Before the waste
went up
Before she had worked
The sunlight in the square—
apples, oranges, the compass
tears of joy—over rotten stone flesh
His dyspepsia uncorked—that's
    leaf of the story
  mitigated

15.

Absolve me from the hatred I never
she—all are wounded against
Zeppelin—wounded carrying dying
three colors over land
thistles again closed around voice.
She is dying—
automatically—
wanting to see you again, but the stone
must be rebuilt. Time stepped

16.

before I started
I was forced to flying
she said.

higher and higher on
next tree, am as wire
when canvas the must spread

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17.

I moved up

glove
the field

18.

I must say I
suddenly
she left the room, oval tear tonelessly fell.

19.

Life pursued down these cliffs.
the omened birds
intrusion; skated, at night
clear waves of weather
fur you bring genius
over hell's curiosity
the librarian shabbily books on
You cannot illusion; the dust.
abstract vermin the garden worn smiles

20.

That something desperate was to be attempted was,
however, quite plain.

21.

Night hunger
of berry . . . stick

22.

"Beautiful morning for a flip miss," remarked the mechanic in brown overalls. "Are you going up alone."

23.

"Then I'll take the bombs out," he said, and at once removed the six powerful bombs from the rack, the projectiles intended for the destruction of Zeppelins.

24.

The tables gleamed—soft lighting

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There was a certain pleasure in all this for him.
The twelve girls wept. She willed him
loveliest diamond of the tree; the old lawyer kept his mule there.
They had gone. The weather was very pure that night like
leaves of paper placed on the black—the opal
crescent still dangled on the little chain—
a pleasant memory of a kiss, completely
given to recollection. Only
faded water remained. The last memory left.

25.

She was dying but had time for him—
brick. Men were carrying the very heavy things—dark purple,
like flowers.
Bowl lighted up the score just right

26.

water
thinking
a

27.

A notice:

28.

wishing you were a
the bottle really before the washed
handed over to her:
hundreds
light over her
hanging her
you can remember

29.

Have you encouraged judge
inked commentary
approaching obvious battle
summer night less ecstatic
train over scream . . . mountain

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30.

sweetheart . . . the stamp
  ballooning you
vision I thought you
forget, encouraging your vital organs.
Telegraph. The rifle—a page folded over.

More upset, wholly meaningless, the willing sheath
glide into fall . . mercury to passing
the war you said won—milling around the picket fence, and
    noise of the engine from the sky
and flowers—here is a bunch
the war won out of cameos.
And somehow the perfect warrior is fallen.

31.

They wore red
the three children dragged into next year
sad . . . gold under the feet.
sadly more music is divine to them.

32.

The snow stopped falling
on the head of the stranger.
In a moment the house would be dark

33.

mirrors—insane

34.

dying for they do not
the hole no crow can
and finally the day of thirst
in the air.
whistles carbon dioxide. Cold
pavement grew. The powerful machine
The tractor, around edge
the listless children. Good night
staining the naughty air
with marvelous rings. You are going there.

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Weeps. The wreath not decorating.
The kids pile over the ample funeral hill.
had arrived from London
o'clock
baited tragically
This time the others grew.
The others waited
by the darkening pool—"a world of silence"
you can't understand their terror
means more to these people waste
the runt crying in the pile of colored
snapshots offal in the wind
that's the way we do it terror
the hand of the large person falls
to the desk. The people all leave.
the industries begin
moments puts on the silencer
You crab into the night

35.

The sheiks protest use of
aims. In the past
coal has protected their
O long, watchful hour.
the engines had been humming
stones of March in the gray woods
still, the rods, could not they take long
More anthems until dust
flocks disguised machine. The stone
the valentine couldn't save . . . Hooks

36.

he ran the machine swiftly across the frosty grass.
Soon he rose, and skimming the trees, soon
soared away into the darkness.

37.

From where Beryl sat she saw the glow
of the little electric bulb set over the instruments shining into
her lover's strong clean-shaven face, and, by the compass,
gathered that
they had described a half-circle, and, though

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still rising rapidly, were now heading eastward in
the direction of the sea.

38.

The roar of the engine, of course,
rendered speech impossible,
while the mist was very chilly, causing her to draw her brown
    woollen comforter around her legs.
There was no sign of light anywhere below
—all was a bright black void.

39.

The few children
Seeds under the glare
The formal tragedy of it all
Mystery for man—engines humming
Parachutes opening.
The newspaper being read
Beside the great gas turbine
The judge calls his assistant over
And together they try to piece together the secret message
    contained in today's paper.

40.

The police
Had been forgotten
Scarlet, blue, and canary
Heads tossing on the page
    grunting to the coatroom
there was another ocean, ballads and legends, the children
  returning to the past—head

41.

She was saying into the distance
    It was a sad day
the riders drinking in the car
haze of trees behind
                dummy woods
  plans and sketches
  soda, glasses, ice
  bumped off
"with these strange symbols."

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42.

the club had bought aperture

43.

Their hidden storage (to you, murder)
but what testimony buried under colored sorrow
—the nerve

children called upon
assassination this racket.

44.

He ran the ferret
backing him hard nest
The chil—
One day the children particularly surrounded
he had read about him.

45.

Like a long room
Monsignor
pushed away it
studio artificially small
pine rounds

46.

The last time she crossed close to Berck,
beyond Paris-Plage, she passed over Folke-
stone, and then over to Cape Gris-Nez
alone into the night

47.

Or he hides bodies
stone night,
pleasant city, gray
hides
perfect dictionary for you
valentine not wanted storm under the
snow backed rubbers
The city hides, desolate
rocks snow tile hides
over the door marked "The literature

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beginning veins hide the mind
robot—"—capped by all. release.

48.

Then she studied her map, took her bearings
and, drawing on her ample gauntlet gloves
(for it had become chilly)
she followed a straight line of railway leading through Suffolk
and Norfolk

49.

I'm on my way to Hull

grinned the girl

50.

It was in German. The aviator and his
observer climbed out of the seats and stood
with Mr. Aylesworth, chatting and laughing.

51.

They are written upon English paper, and English penny stamps
are upon them . . .
they can be put into any post-box . . . They
mostly contain instructions to our good friends in Great
Britain.

52.

The rose
dirt
dirt you
pay
The buildings
is tree
Undecided
protest
This planet

53.

The vegetable wagon had not been placed yet
Scotchmen with their plaids—all the colorful
Photography, horror of all

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That has died
The hundred year old stones—deceived
by the mind of these things—the stairs
climbing up out of dark hollyhocks
old, dirt, smell of the most terrifying thing in the world.

54.

"He is probably one of the gang."

55.

mood seems the sort
to brag
end

56.

songs like
You came back to me
you were wrong about the gravestone
that nettles hide quietly
The son is not ours.

57.

Precise mechanisms
Love us.

He came over the hill
He held me in his arms—it was marvelous.

But the map of Europe
shrinks around naked couples

Even as you lick the stamp
A brown dog lies down beside you and dies

In the city an eleven year old girl with pig tails
Tied with a yellow ribbon takes the trolley

All of this ends somewhere—the book is replaced on the shelf
By an unseen hand

We are not more loved than now
The newspaper is ruining your eyes.

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58.

The professor—a large "S"
One kitten escaped
Take plane
or death by hanging
And naturally it is all over again, beginning to get tired you realize

59.

The real thing the matter
with him you see studio end
of day masked
you didn't see him—he went
escape is over on the lighted steps
"My blood went into this."
Misunderstandings arise cathedral
twenty years later. catching sight of him
his baggy trousers the porch daylight
playing tennis before we realize the final dream is razed
Today, of course.

60.

Wing
Bostonian

and his comments
thirty-three years old the day
of his third birthday the legs
Lenin de Gaulle three days later
also comparing simple

61.

reflecting trout

62.

All of us fear the secret
guarded too carefully
An assortment

63.

she ran along the grass for a short distance
couple of beers
eats being corpse tables

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64.

ice dirt
five minutes
get your money back
    the hole screamed
two persons
                two cut flowers

65.

nothing is better than
glowing coals
The perfect animal
during the summer, sleep of brine and ice

66.

She followed a straight line leading
due north through Suffolk and Norfolk.

67.

over the last few years

there is one terrifying
wild
        the error of sleep
                love

68.

The straight line out of sight
of beads
decades cheapest
the more post card
    "genius"

69.

because it is
That is to say

70.

            Her last dollar

71.

They must hold against
The fire rain

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or when sometime it seems
upward, hands down
    against
pilloried
  sell quickly took her bearings
did not appear entirely
upper hand of her
a height of five thousand feet

72.

The village (using the new headache system) were cut
With the stops running
A French or Swiss
had hit bottom and gotten back up
wild margins are possible
The gold a "call"
options his life . . . flea

73.

A least
four days
A surprise
mothers
suppose
Is not a "images"
to "arrange"
He is a descendant, for example
The Swiss bank—a village

74.

Man come for one is humanity
the lowest pickpocket helps

75.

Like the public,
reactions
from Crystal Palace

76.

A roar
"sweetness and light"
pickpocket—stem

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and more scandalous . . . well, forgotten
The snow is around storm
He laughed lightly at cliff
and used that term

77.

"Perhaps you've heard of her. She's a great flying woman."

"Oh yes," replied the stranger. "I've seen things about
her in the papers. Does she fly much?"

78.

applauding itself—wiser
more gun I come from the district
four times carrying a small,
oval
the movie was also
in the entire crystal

79.

to stroll down Main Street
the dignified and paternal image
telegraph—magnificent

dump
porch
flowers store
weed local relatives
whine

80.

multitude headquarters shout there
Because there are no
because the majority is toxic
An exquisite sense—like pretzels . . .
He was sent to the state senate
wage conceal his disapproval
The arguments situation lawyers worthlessness sullen cafeterias

81.

barcarolle

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82.

The silencer. "Is he not . . ."

83.

Soon after noon, carrying a narrow,

84.

about her

85.

ghost of stone—massive
hangs halfway
polishing
whose winding
Strong, sad half-city
gardens
from the bridge of
stair
broom
recent past symbolized
hair banana
does not evoke a concrete image
the splendid

86.

nourished on the
railings of bare stone—

87.

Your side
is majestic—the dry wind
timeless stones. a deep sigh
dragged up with a piercing scream
the clean, crisp air
aging on the villas

little openings for her bath
facades of the—all alike, the hard rain
"the dignity of this fortress."

88.

the invaders

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so bad just now
go up and see the shabby traveller
ordered a pint
At half-past two, the visitor, taking
his bag, set out on a tour of the
village. An endeavor
remained

rolls on them

at night

89.

This car has some private
more than one cottage the chintzes were bright its
brass candlestick forgotten
twenty-five cents.
could offer was a feeble

90.

I have a perfect memory and

the sky seems to pass
a couple of them like a huge bowl

and encircle the earth

91.

flanked by his lieutenants—lemon--
his chief outside
"If I am wrong
a fine sieve
telephones I do not
strong nature who wrote of him while starving himself

92.

to be dying, he gets them into magazines
and some of them mangy and rabid
hardly seemed necessary.

I was horrified. I felt sorry for him.
No branch without . . .
down to the lakes the ornamental

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bronze—isn't it fear that

Hand in hand like fire
and in your souls

93.

A searchlight sweeping
picked up "The Hornet"
Hardly had he undressed when he
heard again that low swish of
"The Hornet" on her return from scouting circuit of the
  Thames estuary
solidifying disguises

who died in an automobile accident
had developed a
then, imperceptibly

94.

The snow has begun to fall on Paris
It is barely noon

95.

Between the legs of her
Cobwebs the lip reads chewing
and taste seem uncertain;
powerless creating images
shut up and leave me . . . Hush! This
two men who have
  most profoundly
        the islanders

96.

Mr. Bean remained indoors
at the small boats
of our defences, our intentions

97.

out upon the lawn after a few months in the village

    big
"Like some of my friends

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Otherwise we'll chop off his head

98.

This was the third thing
another giant

99.

dark wool, summer
and winter

100.

gun metal—her right foot in both hands
things

101.

the doctor, comb
Sinn Fein

102.

dress

103.

streaming sweeping the surface
long-handled twig-brooms
starving
wall great trees

104.

blaze			aviators	
	out		dastardly	

105.

We must be a little more wary in
future, dear

106.

she was trying to make sense of
what was quick laugh
hotel—cheap for them
caverns the bed

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box of cereal

Ere long a flare was lit
I don't understand wreckage

107.

blue smoke?
It was as though
She had
the river
above the water

The steel bolts
having been replaced
by a painting of
one of wood!
Ronnie, thoughtfully

of the silencer

plot to kill both of us, dear.

pet

oh

it that she was there

108.

the bridge crosses
dragon ships
canal lock
was effect
There are but two seasons
the map of Paris
through the center of the sheet
character
sewers empty into under the
literally choked the river with
bodies
"on the coast, I think . . ."

passing over

109.

Magnificent trees—the old
chateau—he said he was
going home for their needs
only the other—
exchanged another meaning
here lately

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110.

Dry, the bush
settling Everybody

knows him
close to the Thwaite
passing close to where
The bookshop
were crouched in conceal-
up a steep, narrow path
to the summit of Black Hill
recognized him
lavatory—dogging
his footsteps

out to sea

111.

Half an hour later
Ronald recognized him.
They suddenly saw a beam of intense, white light,
A miniature searchlight of great brilliance,
—pierce the darkness, skyward.

They now recognized to be a acetylene,
a cylinder mounted
upon a light tripod of aluminum
with a bright reflector behind the gas jet,
that the light began to "wink,"
three times in quick succession
the Morse letter "S."

Slowly the beam turned from north to south,
making the Morse "S." upon the clouds,
time after time.

Suddenly the light was shut off—for five minutes by
Ronald's watch no flicker was shown
Then suddenly, once again, the series of S's was repeated
in a semicircle from north to south

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and back again.

Another five minutes passed in darkness

Once more the light opened out and commenced
to signal the Morse flashes and flares,
"N.F.", "N.F."
followed by a long beam of
light skyward, slowly sweeping in a circle

the breath

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